

REPORT	Edition	Methodological Factors / Indicators	Top Rank	INDIA'S RANK	ISSUED BY
World Competitiveness Index 2026	**38th**	✧Economic Performance ✧Government Efficiency ✧Business Efficiency ✧Infrastructure	Singapore	**44th (Score - 62.0)**	IMD
World Happiness Report 2026	**14th**	✧Explanatory Factors ↳ Social Support ↳ GDP Per Capita ↳ Healthy Life Expectancy ↳ Freedom to make life choices ↳ Generosity ↳ Perceptions of Corruption	Finland	**116th (Life expectancy - 58.2 years)**	Oxford Wellbeing Research Centre & Gallup & UN Sustainable Development Solutions Network (UNSDSN)
Corruption Perceptions Index (CPI) 2025	**31st**	Steps: ✧Select and standardise data sources ✧Calculate average ✧Report a measure of uncertainty	Denmark	**91st (Score - 39)**	Transparency International
Climate Change Performance Index (CCPI) 2026	**22nd**	It uses 14 indicators and the following four categories: ✧GHG Emissions (40% of overall score) ✧Renewable Energy (20% of overall score) ✧Energy Use (20% of overall score) ✧Climate Policy (20% of overall score)	1st three spots empty (Denmark : 4th spot with Score of 80.52)	**23rd / 63 countries & European Union** (India's Score: 61.31)	Germanwatch, New Climate Institute, Climate Action Network International
Global Peace Index (GPI) 2026	**20th**	It uses 23 qualitative and quantitative indicators to measure the state of peace across three domains: ✧Level of Societal Safety and Security ✧Extent of Ongoing Domestic and International Conflict ✧Degree of Militarisation	Iceland	**127th**	Institute for Economics and Peace (IEP)
World Press Freedom Index 2026	**25th**	5 Indicators: ✧Political context ✧Legal framework ✧Economic environment ✧Socio-cultural context ✧Journalist safety	Norway	**157th**	Reporters Without Borders (RSF)

Human Development Index 2025 (Title - A Matter of Choice: People and Possibilities in the Age of AI)	**34th**	✧Health: measured by life expectancy at birth. ✧Education: measured by two indicators – mean years of schooling (for adults) and expected years of schooling (for children). ✧Standard of living: measured by GDP per capita.	Iceland (Score: 0.972)	**130th (Score: 0.685)**	United Nations Development Programme (UNDP)
Global Firepower Index 2026	**21st**	60 + indicators covering: ✧Manpower and troop levels ✧Air, land and naval equipment ✧Defence budgets and logistics ✧Geography, strategic position and technological capability	USA	**4th** (PwrIndx: 0.1346)	Global Firepower
Henley Passport Index **(As of June 2026)**	**—**	Data comes from exclusive, official records of the International Air Transport Association (IATA)	Singapore (Afghanistan holds lowest ranking)	**80th** (56 visa free access)	Henley & Partners
Global Terrorism Index (GTI) 2026	**13th**	The GTI ranks 163 countries based on four indicators weighted over five years. ✧total number of terrorist incidents in a given year ✧total number of fatalities caused by terrorists in a given year ✧total number of injuries caused by terrorists in a given year ✧total number of hostages caused by terrorists in a given year	Pakistan	**13th**	Institute for Economics & Peace (IEP)
Global Innovation Index (GII) 2025	**18th**	✧The overall score averages Innovation Input Sub-Index (five pillars enabling innovation) and Output Sub-Index (two pillars on results). ✧Pillars cover institutions, human capital, infrastructure, market sophistication, market sophistication, knowledge outputs, and creative outputs.	Switzerland (15th time)	**38th/139** India's strength: Knowledge & Technology Outputs (22nd) and Market Sophistication (38th), showcasing strong research and ICT services.	World Intellectual Property Organization (WIPO)
UN Sustainable Development Report 2026	**11th**	✧Countries are ranked by their spillover score. ✧The Spillover Index assesses such spillovers along three dimensions: environmental & social impacts embodied into trade, economy & finance, and security.	Finland (Score - 87.4) Sweden Denmark	**94th (Score: 68.33)**	UN Sustainable Development Solutions Network (SDSN)
Global Gender Gap Report 2025	**19th**	**The index measures gender gaps in four dimensions:** ✧Economic Participation and Opportunity ✧Educational Attainment ✧Health and Survival ✧Political Empowerment	Iceland (92.6%)	**131st (Score - 0.644)**	World Economic Forum

Global Hunger Index 2025	**20th**	✧Undernourishment ✧Child stunting ✧Child wasting ✧Child mortality	Lowest rank (123rd) - Somalia	**102nd (Score - 25.8)**	Concern world wide & Welthungerhilfe (German institute)
Global Energy Transition Index 2026	**9th**	✧System Performance (22 indicators) - Security - Equity - Sustainability ✧Transition readiness (22 indicators) - Regulatory framework and investment - Enabling factors	Sweden (Score - 75.3)	**70th (Score - 54.9)**	World Economic Forum
Network Readiness Index 2025	**7th**	4 Pillars - ✧Technology ✧People ✧Governance ✧Impact	US (Score - 79.13)	**45th** (Score - 54.43)	Portulans Institute
Logistics Performance Index (LPI) 2023 Introduced big data analytics (container, aviation, and postal tracking) for the first time to objectively measure supply chain speed and logistics bottlenecks.	**7th**	The LPI considers 6 parameters to evaluate logistics performance, namely: ✧Customs performance ✧Infrastructure quality ✧Ease of arranging shipments ✧Logistics services quality ✧Consignment tracking and tracing ✧Timeliness of shipments	Singapore	**38th** (India moved up to 22nd Rank in the Global Ranking in International Shipments category)	World Bank
QS World Rankings 2027	**23rd**	The ranking is based on five lenses: ✧Research and Discovery – 50% ✧Employability and Outcomes – 20% ✧Learning Experience – 10% ✧Global Engagement – 15% ✧Sustainability – 5%	Massachusetts Institute of Technology (MIT)	**IIT Delhi (118th)**	Quacquarelli Symonds (QS)
Global Liveability Index 2026	**23rd**	✧Stability ✧Culture & Environment ✧Healthcare ✧Infrastructure ✧Education	Copenhagen (Denmark) Vienna (Austria) Melbourne (Australia)	**New Delhi:** 120th	Economist Intelligence Unit (EIU)
Environmental Performance Index 2026	**25th**	47 performance indicators, organized into three primary policy objectives: ✧Environmental Health ✧Ecosystem Vitality ✧Climate Change	Estonia (Score - 74.79)	**176th (Score - 22.46)**	Yale Center for Environmental Law and Policy and the Columbia Center for International Earth Science Information Network
Index of Economic Freedom 2026	**32nd**	4 Pillars - ✧Rule of Law ✧Government Size ✧Regulatory Efficiency ✧Open Markets	Singapore (Score - 84.4)	**132nd (Score - 52.5)**	The Heritage Foundation

1. The World Bank's June 2026 Global Economic Prospects report projects global growth to slow to 2.5 percent in 2026.
2. The United Nations Children's Fund (UNICEF) released its flagship Children's Climate Risk Report 2026
   - Extreme Heat: 1.2 billion children face extreme heat conditions, and 1.5 billion are exposed to heatwaves.
   - Drought: Over three-quarters of all children globally (1.8 billion) are exposed to agricultural or meteorological droughts.
   - Additional Threats: Globally, 662 million are exposed to tropical storms, 337 million to riverine floods, and 2.3 billion to detectable levels of air pollution.
   - Around 392 million children in India (92% of the country's youth) are exposed to extreme heat, with 89 million facing recurrent heatwaves.
3. The World Bank's Container Port Performance Index (CPPI) 2025 ranks the Jawaharlal Nehru Port Authority (JNPA) 22nd globally, making it India's top container port.
4. The Stockholm International Peace Research Institute (SIPRI) released its SIPRI Yearbook 2026 on June 8, 2026.

MAJOR ARMED CONFLICTS AND ESTIMATED CONFLICT-RELATED FATALITIES, 2025

Estimated conflict-related fatalities

Location	2025	Change (%), 2024–25
Ukraine	78 350[a]	6
Sudan	18 447	11
Israel–Palestine	16 933	–44
Myanmar	15 468	–23
Nigeria	12 096	22

Note: Based on data from the Armed Conflict Location and Event Data (ACLED) project. Other public sources suggest higher fatality rates in some cases. Major armed conflicts involve over 10 000 conflict-related fatalities.

✧Estimated fatalities in Ukraine include fatalities of Russians and North Koreans fighting there. According to ACLED data, there were a further 1856 conflict-related fatalities in Russia in 2025.

TOP 15 MILITARY SPENDERS, 2025

Country	Spending (US$ b.)	Change (%), 2024–25
1 United States	954	-7.5
2 China	[336]	7.4
3 Russia	[190]	5.9
4 Germany	114	24
5 India	92.1	8.9
6 United Kingdom	89.0	-2.0
7 Ukraine	[84.1]	20
8 Saudi Arabia	[83.2]	1.4
9 France	68.0	1.5
10 Japan	62.2	9.7
11 Israel	48.3	-4.9
12 Italy	48.1	20
13 South Korea	47.8	2.6
14 Poland	46.8	23
15 Spain	40.2	50
Subtotal top 15	**2304**	**....**
World	**2887**	**2.9**

THE MAIN SUPPLIERS AND RECIPIENTS OF MAJOR ARMS, 2021–25

1 USA	42.0	1 Ukraine	9.7
2 France	9.8	2 India	8.2
3 Russia	6.8	3 Saudi Arabia	6.8
4 Germany	5.7	4 Qatar	6.4
5 China	5.6	5 Pakistan	4.2
6 Italy	5.1	6 Japan	3.9
7 Israel	4.4	7 Poland	3.6
8 UK	3.4	8 USA	2.9
9 South Korea	3.0	9 Kuwait	2.8
10 Spain	2.3	10 Australia	2.8



5. Global Forest Resources Assessment (GFRA) 2025

- Released by: Food and Agriculture Organization (FAO)
- Total global forest area is ~4.14 billion hectares, covering ~32% of Earth's land area.
- The annual rate of net forest loss fell from 10.7 million ha (1990–2000) to 4.12 million ha (2015–2025).

- India has moved up to 9th position globally in terms of total forest area as per GFRA 2025.
- India continues to maintain 3rd position worldwide in terms of net annual forest area gain.
- India ranked 5th among the top global carbon sinks, with its forests removing 150 Mt of CO_2 per year during 2021-2025.
- Globally India accounts for approximately 72,739 thousand hectares of forest area which is roughly 2 % of the world total.
- Europe has the largest forest area, accounting for 25 percent of the world's total. South America has the highest proportion of forest, at 49 percent of the total land area.

6 World Air Quality Report 2024

- Released by Swiss air-quality technology company IQAir in March 2025, analyses annual PM2.5 data from over 40,000 monitoring stations across 8,954 locations in 138 countries/territories.
- India was the **5th most polluted country in 2024**, with an average PM2.5 concentration of 50.6 µg/m³—over 10 times the WHO annual guideline of 5 µg/m³.
- **Byrnihat**, on the Assam–Meghalaya border, was the world's most polluted metropolitan area, with annual PM2.5 of **128.2 µg/m³**.
- **Delhi** remained the world's most polluted capital city, with annual PM2.5 of **91.6 µg/m³**.
- Most polluted country: Chad (91.8 µg/m³)

7 Global Business Complexity Index (GBCI) 2025

- It is an annual TMF Group index that ranks jurisdictions by the difficulty of establishing, operating and administering a business.
- GBCI 2025 evaluates complexity in:
  - Accounting and tax
  - Global entity management
  - Human resources and payroll
- Rank **1 (Greece) denotes the most complex** jurisdiction for operating a business.
- **India was ranked 18th** among the 79 jurisdictions in GBCI 2025.
- The **Cayman Islands** ranked **79th (last)**.

8 Ease of Doing Business (EoDB) Index

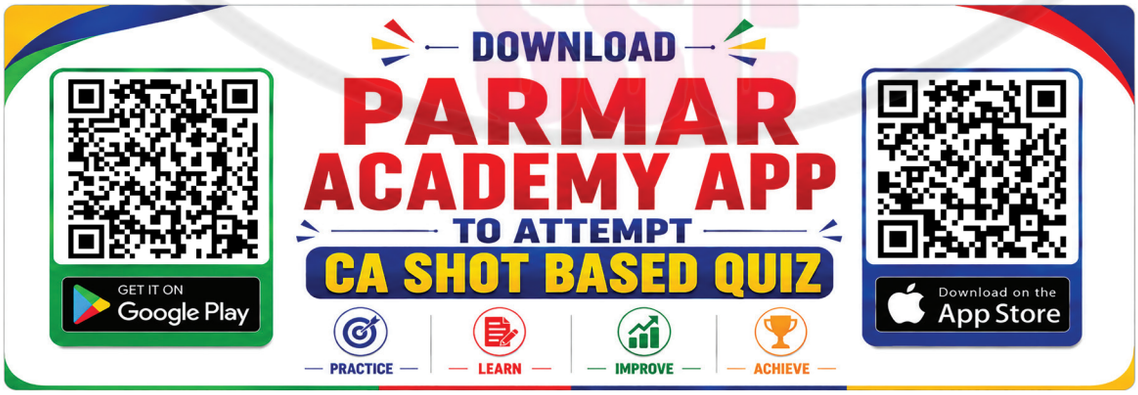
- The **Ease of Doing Business (EoDB) Index** was a World Bank ranking of how conducive an economy's regulatory environment was to the life cycle of a standard domestic small or medium limited-liability firm. Economies were ranked from **1 to 190**, where **rank 1 was best**.
- The World Bank **discontinued the Doing Business report and EoDB rankings in September 2021** after finding data irregularities. Therefore, there is **no current EoDB Index**; the final edition was **Doing Business 2020**, using data up to May 2019.
- India ranked **63rd out of 190 economies** in Doing Business 2020, improving from 77th in the preceding edition. India's **Distance to Frontier / ease-of-doing-business score was 71.0 out of 100**.

Indicator	What it measured
Starting a business	**Number of procedures, time, cost, and paid-in minimum capital needed to establish a company**
Dealing with construction permits	**Procedures, time and cost to build a standard warehouse; also the Building Quality Control Index**

Getting electricity	**Procedures, time and cost to obtain a permanent electricity connection; reliability of supply and tariff transparency**
Registering property	**Procedures, time and cost to transfer commercial property; quality of land-administration system**
Getting credit	**Strength of legal rights of borrowers/lenders; depth, coverage and quality of credit information**
Protecting minority investors	**Disclosure rules, directors' liability, shareholders' ability to sue, shareholder rights, ownership/control safeguards and corporate transparency**
Paying taxes	**Number of annual tax payments, time needed for compliance, total tax and contribution rate, and the post-filing process**
Trading across borders	**Time and cost for documentary compliance and border compliance in exporting/importing goods**
Enforcing contracts	**Time, cost and quality of judicial processes for resolving a standard commercial dispute**
Resolving insolvency	**Time, cost and recovery rate in insolvency proceedings; strength of insolvency-law framework**

9. GLOBAL CITIES INDEX 2025

- The **Global Cities Index** commonly refers to the **Oxford Economics Global Cities Index**, which ranks the world's **1,000 largest urban economies**. Its latest 2025 edition evaluates cities using **27 indicators** across five dimensions: economics, human capital, quality of life, environment and governance.
- Rank 1: New York
- The Index covers **91 Indian cities** among the global 1,000 largest cities. India ranks third globally in the number of cities included, after China (159) and the United States (92), based on the 2024 dataset.
- World Bank Global Remittances Inflow Report 2024: India was the largest remittance recipient, receiving US$129 billion, or 14.3% of global remittance inflows.





1. FISCAL HEALTH INDEX 2026 (FY 2023-24)

- **NITI Aayog** released the second edition of its **"Fiscal Health Index"** under former Vice-Chairman **Suman Bery** and former CEO **Nidhi Chhibber**, with **Odisha** ranking first (score: 73.1), followed by **Goa (54.7)** and **Jharkhand (50.5).**
- **Methodology:** It evaluates states based on five core pillars:

- Quality of Expenditure
- Revenue Mobilisation
- Fiscal Prudence
- Debt Index
- Debt Sustainability

- **Expanded Scope:** The 2026 Fiscal Health Index (FHI) expanded its scope to include **10 North-Eastern and Himalayan states** alongside the **18 major states**, calculating scores for **FY 2023–24** based on official **CAG** data.

Results

18 Major States

States	FHI Score	Rank 2023–24
Odisha	73.1	1
Goa	54.7	2
Jharkhand	50.5	3
Gujarat	49.9	4
Maharashtra	45.0	5
Chhattisgarh	44.3	6
Telangana	44.3	7
Uttar Pradesh	41.9	8
Karnataka	41.7	9
Madhya Pradesh	37.8	10
Haryana	34.5	11

NE/ Himalayan States

States	FHI Score	Rank 2023–24
Arunachal Pradesh	59.5	1
Uttarakhand	52.5	2
Tripura	44.1	3
Meghalaya	41.5	4
Assam	39.1	5
Mizoram	33.4	6
Sikkim	32.5	7
Nagaland	27.1	8
Himachal Pradesh	22.0	9
Manipur	17.6	10

States	FHI Score	Rank 2023–24
Bihar	30.9	12
Tamil Nadu	29.8	13
Rajasthan	27.6	14
Kerala	24.8	15
West Bengal	23.8	16
Andhra Pradesh	23.1	17
Punjab	12.4	18



2. NATIONAL FAMILY HEALTH SURVEY – 6

- NFHS-6 was conducted during 2023-24 by the Ministry of Health and Family Welfare (MoHFW) with the **International Institute for Population Sciences (IIPS), Mumbai** as the nodal agency.
- **Coverage:** 6.79 lakh households across 715 districts

Key findings:

- India's Total Fertility Rate (TFR) remains at 2.0.
- The Contraceptive Prevalence Rate (CPR) increased from 66.7% to 69.1%
- Full vaccination coverage among children aged 12-23 months based on vaccination cards, increased from 83.8% to 87.1%.
- **Maternal Healthcare & Antenatal Care (ANC)**

- Antenatal Care (ANC): 95.9% of pregnant women received ANC, with first-trimester visits rising to 76.2%.
- Continuity of Care: Mothers completing at least four ANC visits increased to 65.2%.
- Nutritional Support: Significant rise in Iron Folic Acid consumption, up to 54.9% for 100+ days and 37.8% for 180+ days.

- **Institutional Births & Newborn Care**

- Institutional Deliveries: Increased to 90.6%, nearing universal coverage.
- Skilled Assistance: Births attended by skilled health personnel reached 91.3%.
- Postnatal Care: Care for newborns within two days of delivery improved to 85.3%.

- **Family Planning & Fertility**

- Total Fertility Rate (TFR): Remains stable at 2.0, sustaining the replacement-level fertility status achieved in the previous survey.
- Contraceptive Prevalence: Usage of family planning methods (CPR) increased from 66.7% to 69.1%.
- Strategic Impact: Gains are attributed to sustained national initiatives like Mission Parivar Vikas.

- **Child Immunization Progress**

- Full Vaccination Coverage: Increased to 87.1% for children aged 12–23 months.
- Public Trust: 95.6% of vaccinations were administered through public health facilities, highlighting strong community confidence.

- **Targeted Success:**

- Rotavirus Coverage: Significant leap from 36.4% to 85.4%.
- Measles (2nd Dose): Coverage rose from 58.6% to 71.8%.
- Baseline Consistency: Over 96% of children received at least one vaccine.

- Child Health Improvements

- Disease Prevalence: Reported cases of Acute Respiratory Infection (ARI) dropped to 1.9%, and severe diarrhoea declined to 0.5%.
- Key Enablers: These outcomes were driven by the Universal Immunization Programme (UIP), improved cold chain infrastructure, and digital systems like the U-WIN portal.

- **Breastfeeding & Early Nutrition**

- Breastfeeding Rates: 95.6% of children under six months were breastfed during the survey period.
- Early Initiation: Timely initiation of breastfeeding (within one hour of birth) for children under three years improved significantly, rising from 41.8% to 50.1%.
- Complementary Feeding: The proportion of children (6–8 months) receiving solid or semi-solid food alongside breastmilk increased from 45.9% to 59.5%.

Key Nutritional Status Indicators

- Stunting (Long-term growth): Prevalence among children under five years declined significantly from 35.5% to 29.3%.
- Wasting (Acute malnutrition): Severe wasting saw a sharp decline from 7.7% to 5.2%.
- Underweight: The prevalence of underweight children under five registered a marginal decline, moving from 32.1% to 31.8%.

Drivers of Progress

- Flagship Initiatives: Gains are driven by multi-ministerial efforts, specifically POSHAN Abhiyaan, Saksham Anganwadi, and POSHAN 2.0.
- Service Delivery: Enhanced ICDS operations and targeted National Health Mission (NHM) interventions, including Nutrition Rehabilitation Centres (NRCs), the Mother's Absolute Affection (MAA) program, and routine growth monitoring, have been instrumental in these improved outcomes.

3. LOGISTICS EASE ACROSS DIFFERENT STATES

The 7th edition of the **'Logistics Ease Across Different States'** (LEADS) 2025 Report was officially released by the Department for Promotion of Industry and Internal Trade (DPIIT) under the Ministry of Commerce and Industry.

Category	Coastal States	Landlocked States	NE States	UTs
Exemplars	Tamil Nadu	UP	Mizoram	Delhi
High Performers	Gujarat, Maharashtra, Kerala	Haryana, Telangana, Chhattisgarh, Bihar	Tripura, Meghalaya	Jammu & Kashmir, Puducherry
Accelerators	Andhra Pradesh, Odisha, Goa, Karnataka	Punjab, Jharkhand, Madhya Pradesh, Uttarakhand, Himachal Pradesh	Nagaland, Arunachal Pradesh, Manipur, Assam	DNHDD, Chhattisgarh, Ladakh, Lakshadweep
Growth Seekers	West Bengal	Rajasthan	Sikkim	Andaman & Nicobar Islands

4. EXPORT PREPAREDNESS INDEX (EPI) 2024

- Publisher: NITI Aayog
- The first edition of the EPI was published in August 2020
- The index is structured around **4 pillars** (Export Infrastructure, Business Ecosystem, Policy & Governance and Export Performance), further disaggregated into 13 sub-pillars and 70 indicators.
- The states are divided into two major categories - Large States and Small States, NE & UTs based on the aspects of land area, population and GSDP.
- Within the categories, EPI 2024 classifies the states as **"Leaders, Challengers, and Aspirers"** based on their scores.

Category	Leading Performers
Large States	Maharashtra, Tamil Nadu, Gujarat, Uttar Pradesh and Andhra Pradesh
Small States, North Eastern States & Union Territories	Uttarakhand, Jammu and Kashmir, Nagaland, Dadra and Nagar Haveli & Daman and Diu and Goa

5. INDIA STATE OF FOREST REPORT (ISFR) 2023

- The ISFR is brought out by the Forest Survey of India (FSI) on a biennial basis since 1987.
- The India State of Forest Report 2023 is 18th such report in the series.
- The report contains information on forest cover, tree cover, mangrove cover, growing stock, carbon stock in India's forests, instances of forest fire, Agroforestry, etc.

- The total forest and tree cover is 8,27,357sq km, which is 25.17 percent of the geographical area of the country.

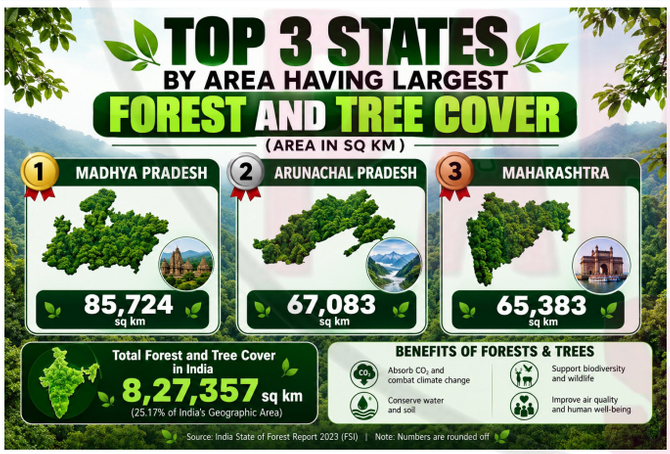


- The forest cover has an area of about 7,15,343 sq km (21.76%) whereas the tree cover has an area of 1,12,014 sq km (3.41%).

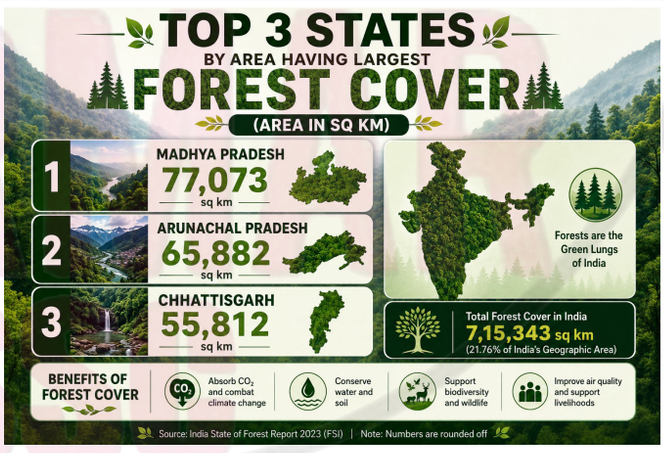


- As compared to 2021, there is an increase of 1445 sq km in the total forest and tree cover of the country, which includes 156 sq km increase in the forest cover and 1289 sq km increase in tree cover.

- Area wise top three states having largest forest and tree cover are Madhya Pradesh (85,724 sq km) followed by Arunachal Pradesh (67,083 sq km) and Maharashtra (65,383 sq km).



- Area wise top three states having largest forest cover are Madhya Pradesh (77,073 sq km) followed by Arunachal Pradesh (65,882 sq km) and Chhattisgarh (55,812 sq km).



- Top four states showing maximum increase in forest and tree cover are Chhattisgarh (684 sq km) followed by Uttar Pradesh (559 sq km), Odisha (559 sq km) and Rajasthan (394 sq km).
- Top three states showing maximum increase in forest cover are Mizoram (242 sq km) followed by Gujarat (180 sq km) and Odisha (152 sq km).
- In terms of percentage of forest cover with respect to total geographical area, Lakshadweep (91.33 percent) has the highest forest cover followed by Mizoram (85.34 percent) and Andaman & Nicobar Island (81.62 percent).
- The total mangrove cover is 4,992 sq km in the country.

6. LOGISTICS PORT PERFORMANCE INDEX (LPPI)

India launched the **Logistics Port Performance Index (LPPI)** for FY 2024-25 and FOUR major digital initiatives aimed at improving governance, transparency and ease of doing business across the shipping ecosystem.

- The initiatives were launched by Union Minister of Ports, Shipping and Waterways (MoPSW), Sarbananda Sonowal during the 37th Foundation Day celebrations of the Jawaharlal Nehru Port Authority (JNPA) in Mumbai, Maharashtra.
- The index evaluates ports across three cargo segments: Dry Bulk, Liquid Bulk, and Container Cargo.
- **Top Performers:**

- Dry Bulk: Paradip Port Authority (Odisha)
- Liquid Bulk: Sikka Port and Terminals (Gujarat)
- Container Cargo: Mundra Port (Gujarat)

7. PRISON STATISTICS INDIA 2024 REPORT

The National Crime Records Bureau (NCRB) released the comprehensive **Prison Statistics India 2024 report**.

Metric	2024 Figure
Total Number of Jails	1,333
Sanctioned Capacity	4.53 lakh inmates
Actual Inmate Population	5.11 lakh inmates
National Occupancy Rate	112.7% (down from 120.8% in 2023)

- The drop to a 112.7% national average hides severe regional disparities, with more than half of India's States and Union Territories operating past maximum capacity.

- Highest Occupancy: Delhi (194.6%), Meghalaya (163.5%), Jammu & Kashmir (148.3%), and Madhya Pradesh (147.1%).
- Significant Drop: Chhattisgarh successfully reduced its extreme 234% occupancy rate from 2015 down to 127.6% in 2024.

8. ALL INDIA SURVEY ON HIGHER EDUCATION (AISHE): 2022-23 & 2023-24

Gross Enrolment Ratio (GER)

- The GER, which was 23.7 in 2014-15 has been continuously increasing and reached 29.5 in 2022-23 and 30 in 2023-24. Female GER has risen to 31.2 in 2023-24 from 30.2 in 2022-23 and 22.9 in 2014-15.
- The GER of Scheduled Castes (SC) students have increased to 27.8 in 2023-24 from 18.9 in 2014-15. The GER of Scheduled Tribes (ST) students have increased to 22.8 in 2023-24 from 13.5 in 2014-15.

Gender Parity Index (GPI)

- The ratio of female GER to male GER is computed as the Gender Parity Index (GPI) which measures the relative access to education of males and females. The GPI for 2023-24 stands at 1.08. The GPI has remained above 1.0 for seven consecutive years, indicating consistently higher female participation in higher education.

Enrolment

- The enrolment in higher education has been continuously increasing from 3.42 crore in 2014-15 to 4.46 crore in 2022-23 and 4.50 crore in 2023-24 (i.e. 31.5% increase since 2014-15). In fact, there was a commendable increase in female enrolment in higher education from 1.57 crore in 2014-15 to 2.18 crore in 2022-23 and 2.24 crore in 2023-24 (i.e. 42.2% increase since 2014-15).
- The enrolment of SC students has increased to 69.72 lakh in 2023-24 from 46.07 lakh in 2014-15 (an increase of 51.4% since 2014-15). The enrolment of ST students has increased to 28.83 lakh in 2023-24 from 16.41 lakh in 2014-15 (an increase of 75.7% since 2014-15). Similarly, the enrolment of Other Backward Classes (OBC) students has increased to 1.80 crore in 2023-24 from 1.13 crore in 2014-15 (60.2% increase).

STEM enrolment

- STEM enrolment has risen significantly over the past decade, from 91.5 lakh in 2014-15 to 1.02 crore in 2023-24, reflecting the growing emphasis on science, technology, engineering, and mathematics education in the country.
- The share of female students in STEM enrolment has also shown a steady improvement over the years, rising from 38.4% in 2014-15 to 44% in 2023-24, reflecting growing gender inclusivity in science, technology, engineering, and mathematics education in the country.

9. PERIODIC LABOUR FORCE SURVEY (PLFS) ANNUAL REPORT, 2025

- **Labour Force Participation Rate (LFPR):**

Table 1: Labour Force Participation Rate (in per cent) in usual status (ps+ss) estimated from PLFS 2022, PLFS 2023, PLFS 2024 and PLFS 2025 for persons of age 15 years and above and persons of all ages

(all india)

Age Group	Rural			Urban			Rural+Urban		
	Male	Female	Person	Male	Female	Person	Male	Female	Person
1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10
PLFS 2025									
15 years and above	80.5	45.9	62.8	76.2	27.7	52.2	79.1	40.0	59.3
All ages	58.8	34.6	46.6	59.7	22.2	41.3	59.1	30.7	44.9

- **Worker Population Ratio:**

Table 2: Worker Population Ratio (in per cent) in usual status (ps+ss) estimated from PLFS 2022, PLFS 2023, PLFS 2024 and PLFS 2025 for persons of age 15 years and above and persons of all ages

(all india)

Age Group	Rural			Urban			Rural+Urban		
	Male	Female	Person	Male	Female	Person	Male	Female	Person
1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10
PLFS 2025									
15 years and above	78.4	44.9	61.2	73.0	25.9	49.7	76.6	38.8	57.4
All ages	57.2	33.8	45.4	57.2	20.7	39.3	57.2	29.8	43.5

- **Unemployment Ratio:**

Table 3: Unemployment Rate (in per cent) in usual status (ps+ss) estimated from PLFS 2022, PLFS 2023, PLFS 2024 and PLFS 2025 for persons of age 15 years and above and persons of all ages

(all india)

Age Group	Rural			Urban			Rural+Urban		
	Male	Female	Person	Male	Female	Person	Male	Female	Person
1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10
PLFS 2025									
15 years and above	2.6	2.1	2.4	4.2	6.4	4.8	3.1	3.1	3.1
All ages	2.6	2.1	2.4	4.2	6.4	4.8	3.1	3.1	3.1

10. SUSTAINABLE DEVELOPMENT GOALS – NATIONAL INDICATOR FRAMEWORK PROGRESS REPORT, 2026

- Tracks all 17 SDGs using 277 national indicators.
- **Social & Health Progress**

- **Social Protection:** Coverage surged from 22.0% (2016) to 65.3% (2026).
- **Maternal Mortality:** Declined from 122 to 87 per 100,000 live births (2015–17 vs. 2022–24).
- **Sex Ratio at Birth:** Improved from 896 to 918 females per 1,000 males (2015–17 vs. 2022–24).

- **Economic & Employment Shifts**

- **Unemployment Rate:** Cut nearly in half, dropping from 6.1% (2017-18) to 3.1% (2025).
- **Gender Equality in Workforce:** The ratio of female-to-male professional and technical workers rose from 48.7% (2023–24) to 51.3% (2025).

- **Infrastructure, Energy & Technology**

- **Renewable Energy:** Per capita capacity tripled from 64.04 to 193.36 watts (2014-15 vs. 2025–26).
- **Waste Management:** Recycling plants increased nearly fourfold, from 829 to 3,236 (2019–20 vs. 2025–26).
- **Digital Connectivity:** Internet subscriptions more than tripled, soaring from 302.36 million (2015) to 969.10 million (2025).

- **Environment & Biodiversity Conservation**

- **Wetlands Protection:** Ramsar sites increased from 4.15% to 8.66% of total wetland area (2016 vs. 2026).
- **Genetic Resources Conserved (2014–15 vs. 2025–26):**
  - Plant: Increased from 4,32,564 to 4,91,864.
  - Animal: More than doubled, from 1,40,364 to 3,61,794.
  - Fish: More than doubled, from 47 to 105.

11. NORTH EASTERN REGION (NER) DISTRICT SDG INDEX 2023–24

- The 2nd edition was released by **NITI Aayog and the Ministry of Development of North Eastern Region (MDoNER)**, with technical support from UNDP.
- Coverage and method:
  - Covers **121 districts** across Arunachal Pradesh, Assam, Manipur, Meghalaya, Mizoram, Nagaland, Sikkim and Tripura.
  - Assessed progress through **84 indicators across 15 SDGs;** SDG 14 (Life Below Water) and SDG 17 (Partnerships for the Goals) are not included in the district scoring.

Category	Composite Score
Achiever	100
Front Runner	65 to below 100
Performer	50 to below 65
Aspirant	Below 50

- **Key findings:**
  - Scores ranged from 58.71 in Longding, Arunachal Pradesh to 81.43 in Hnahthial, Mizoram.
  - Hnahthial (Mizoram) ranked first in the NER; the next four were Champhai (Mizoram), Gomati (Tripura), Mokokchung (Nagaland), and West Tripura (Tripura).
  - About 85% of assessed districts were Front Runners, an improvement from 62% in the previous NER district index.
  - Every district in Mizoram, Sikkim and Tripura attained Front Runner status.
  - No district was in the Aspirant category, and no district attained the Achiever score of 100.

12. URBAN GOVERNANCE INDEX (UGI) 2024

- It is the second edition of a national index prepared by the **Praja Foundation** to assess how far state governments have structurally empowered city governments.
- It builds on the UGI 2020 and examines implementation of the 74th Constitutional Amendment's spirit of democratic, accountable urban local governance.
- Coverage and Framework: Uses **42 indicators**, grouped into **13 sub-themes** and **four themes**, with a total possible score of 100.
- Rank 1: Kerala (59.31)
- The national average was **39.70/100**. The five lowest-ranked jurisdictions were **Nagaland, Manipur, Meghalaya, Punjab and Chandigarh**.

13. AIR QUALITY INDEX (AQI)

- **India launched the National Air Quality Index in 2014**.
- It is administered by the **Central Pollution Control Board (CPCB)** under the Ministry of Environment, Forest and Climate Change and requires data for at least **three pollutants**, one of which must be either **PM2.5** or **PM10**, to calculate AQI.
- Computes the National AQI on a scale from **0 to 500**.
- India's AQI uses pollutant-specific sub-indices for **eight pollutants:** (PM10, PM2.5, NO2, SO2, CO, O3, NH3, and Pb).
- Comprehensive Environmental Pollution Index (CEPI)
- It is a composite index developed by the **Central Pollution Control Board (CPCB)**, formulated in **2009**, to assess the overall environmental quality of **industrial clusters/areas** in India. Its score ranges from **0 to 100**.
- CEPI combines pollution impacts on three environmental media: Air, Surface water & Land/groundwater
- It uses the Source ⟶ Pathway ⟶ Receptor approach
- Classification of industrial areas:

CEPI score	Classification
70 and above	Critically Polluted Area (CPA)
60 to below 70	Severely Polluted Area (SPA)
Below 60	Other Polluted Area (OPA)

14 WHOLESALE PRICE INDEX (WPI)

- The Wholesale Price Index (WPI) measures the average change over time in prices of goods sold in bulk at the early stage of transactions - such as at the farm mandi, mine or factory gate.
- It measures producer/wholesale-level inflation, not the prices paid by final consumers.
- Compiled and released monthly by the **Office of the Economic Adviser (OEA), DPIIT, Ministry of Commerce and Industry**.
- India shifted to the new **WPI base year 2022–23 = 100** in 2026, replacing the 2011–12 series. The new WPI series is issued alongside an Output Producer Price Index (PPI).
- WPI broadly covers goods under three major groups: Primary Articles, Fuel and Power & Manufactured Products.

15. CONSUMER PRICE INDEX (CPI)

- The Consumer Price Index (CPI) measures changes over time in the retail prices of goods and services purchased by households. It is India's main indicator of retail inflation and cost-of-living changes.
- India's current official CPI series uses **base year 2024 = 100**, introduced in February 2026 and based on the **Household Consumption Expenditure Survey (HCES) 2023–24**. It replaced the CPI series with base year 2012 = 100.
- The **National Statistical Office (NSO), MoSPI** compiles and releases CPI data separately for **rural, urban and combined India.**

16. SDG INDIA INDEX 2023–24

- The SDG India Index 2023–24 is the fourth edition of NITI Aayog's framework for tracking India's national and subnational progress towards the UN Sustainable Development Goals.
- It evaluates all States and Union Territories using 113 indicators across 16 SDGs; SDG 17 is not given a goal score.
- India's composite SDG score rose to **71/100**, from **66 in 2020–21** and **57 in the 2018 baseline**.
- Scores ranged from **57 (Bihar)** to **79 (Kerala and Uttarakhand)** across States and UTs.
- Leading UT: Chandigarh, Lowest State Score: Bihar

Score	Classification
0–49	Aspirant
50–64	Performer
65–99	Front Runner
100	Achiever

- 32 of 36 States/UTs were classified as Front Runners.

17. NATIONAL MULTIDIMENSIONAL POVERTY INDEX (MPI)

- India's **National Multidimensional Poverty Index (MPI)**, developed by **NITI Aayog** with UNDP and OPHI, measures overlapping household deprivations - not income poverty alone. It uses the Alkire–Foster methodology.
- The National MPI has **three equally weighted dimensions** and **12 indicators:**

Dimension	Weight	Indicators
Health	1/3	Nutrition; child and adolescent mortality; maternal health
Education	1/3	Years of schooling; school attendance
Standard of living	1/3	Cooking fuel; sanitation; drinking water; electricity; housing; assets; bank account

- India retains the Global MPI's 10 core indicators and adds **maternal health** and **bank account** as two national indicators.
- The second National MPI report, based on **NFHS-5 (2019–21)**, covered **36 States/UTs and 707 districts**.
- An estimated **13.5 crore people** moved out of multidimensional poverty during 2015–16 to 2019–21, a decline of **9.89 percentage points** in the poverty headcount ratio.

18. 16TH FINANCE COMMISSION (XVI-FC)

- Chaired by Dr Arvind Panagariya, covers **2026–27 to 2030–31**.

Subject	XVI-FC recommendation
Vertical devolution	States retain 41% of the divisible pool of Union taxes—unchanged from the 15th FC. The report also calls for disclosure of CAG-certified net tax proceeds for greater transparency.
Horizontal devolution	Distribution among States: income distance 42.5%, population (2011) 17.5%, demographic performance 10%, area 10%, forest 10%, and contribution to GDP 10%.
Major change	The 10% GDP-contribution criterion replaces the 15th FC's tax-effort and fiscal-effort criteria. Income-distance weight declines from 45% under the 15th FC to 42.5%.
Total grants	₹9.47 lakh crore over five years, confined to local bodies and disaster management.
Grants discontinued	Revenue-deficit grants, sector-specific grants and state-specific grants are discontinued.
Centre's fiscal deficit	Reduce it to 3.5% of GDP by 2030–31.
States' fiscal deficit	Annual ceiling of 3% of GSDP, excluding loans under the Special Assistance to States for Capital Investment scheme.
Off-budget borrowing	End off-budget borrowings; include all such liabilities uniformly in fiscal-deficit and debt calculations.

Criteria	15th FC (2021-26)	16th FC (2026-31)
Income Distance	45 %	42.5 %
Population (2011)	15 %	17.5 %
Demographic Performance	**12.5 %**	**10 %**
Area	15 %	10 %
Forest	10 %	10 %
Tax and Fiscal Efforts	2.5 %	—
Contribution to GDP	—	**10 %**

PER CAPITA GSDP DISTANCE (INCOME DISTANCE):

- The 16th FC has defined income distance as the difference between the per capita GSDP of a state and the average of the per capita GSDP of the top three large states with the highest per capita GSDP.
- Per capita GSDP has been computed as the average over the period 2018-19 and 2023-24, excluding the pandemic year of 2020-21.
- **States with a lower per capita GSDP** will receive a **higher share** on this parameter, to maintain equity among states.

DEMOGRAPHIC PERFORMANCE:

- The 15th FC had introduced this parameter to award states for controlling population on the basis of **Total Fertility Rate (TFR)**.
- The 16th FC has redefined this to account for population growth between **1971** and **2011** instead of relying on change in TFR. States with lower population growth will have a higher share under this parameter.

FOREST:

- The 16th FC has assigned weightage to both the share of a state in the overall forest area, and its share in the increase in overall forest area between 2015 and 2023.
- Further, it has also considered open forests in arriving at the total forest area. In contrast, the 15th FC had considered **only dense and moderately dense forests**, and defined the parameter only in terms of share in the overall forest area.

CONTRIBUTION TO GDP:

- The 16th FC has introduced this parameter to account for the contribution to national GDP.
- This replaces the tax and fiscal efforts parameter used by the 15th FC which rewarded states with a higher tax collection efficiency.
- GSDP of each state has been measured as the average nominal GSDP between 2018-19 and 2023-24 (excluding the pandemic year of 2020-21).

GRANTS AND DISASTER MANAGEMENT:

- **Local bodies:** ₹7.91 lakh crore—₹4.35 lakh crore for rural local bodies and ₹3.56 lakh crore for urban local bodies. Grants comprise 80% basic grants and 20% performance grants.
- **State disaster funds:** ₹2,04,401 crore for SDRF and SDMF; Centre–State sharing is 90:10 for North-Eastern/Himalayan States and 75:25 for other States. The Union share is ₹1,55,916 crore.
- **Newly recommended disaster categories:** The Commission recommended inclusion of heatwaves and lightning as notified disasters. They were added to the SDRF/NDRF operational guidelines in August 2026.

19. ECONOMIC SURVEY 2025–26

- India's first **Economic Survey** was presented in **1950–51** as part of the Union Budget documents.
- It was separated from the Union Budget in **1964** and has since been presented annually in Parliament before the Union Budget, usually by the Union Finance Minister. The Survey is prepared by the **Economic Division of the Department of Economic Affairs, Ministry of Finance**.
- India's first **Economic Census** was conducted in **1977**.
- **Economic Survey 2025–26** assesses FY 2025–26 and projects the outlook for FY 2026–27.

Indicator	Key finding
Real GDP growth, FY26	**7.4%** estimated
Real GVA growth, FY26	**7.3%** estimated
GDP growth outlook, FY27	6.8%–7.2%
Centre's fiscal deficit, FY26	Estimated to be below **4.5% of GDP**
Forex reserves	**$701.4 billion** as of 16 January 2026 - covering about 11 months of imports and 94% of external debt
Current-account deficit	**0.8% of GDP in H1 FY26, down from 1.3% in H1 FY25**

GROWTH DRIVERS:

- Private consumption and investment are identified as the main "double engines" of growth. Private Final Consumption Expenditure grew 7.0% in FY26 and accounted for 61.5% of GDP—the highest share since FY 2011–12.
- Gross fixed capital formation grew 7.8%, maintaining investment at around 30% of GDP; public capital expenditure and a recovery in private investment were key supports.
- Manufacturing recovery strengthened: manufacturing GVA grew 7.72% in Q1 and 9.13% in Q2 of FY26.
- The industrial sector grew 7% in H1 FY26, compared with 6% in the corresponding period a year earlier.

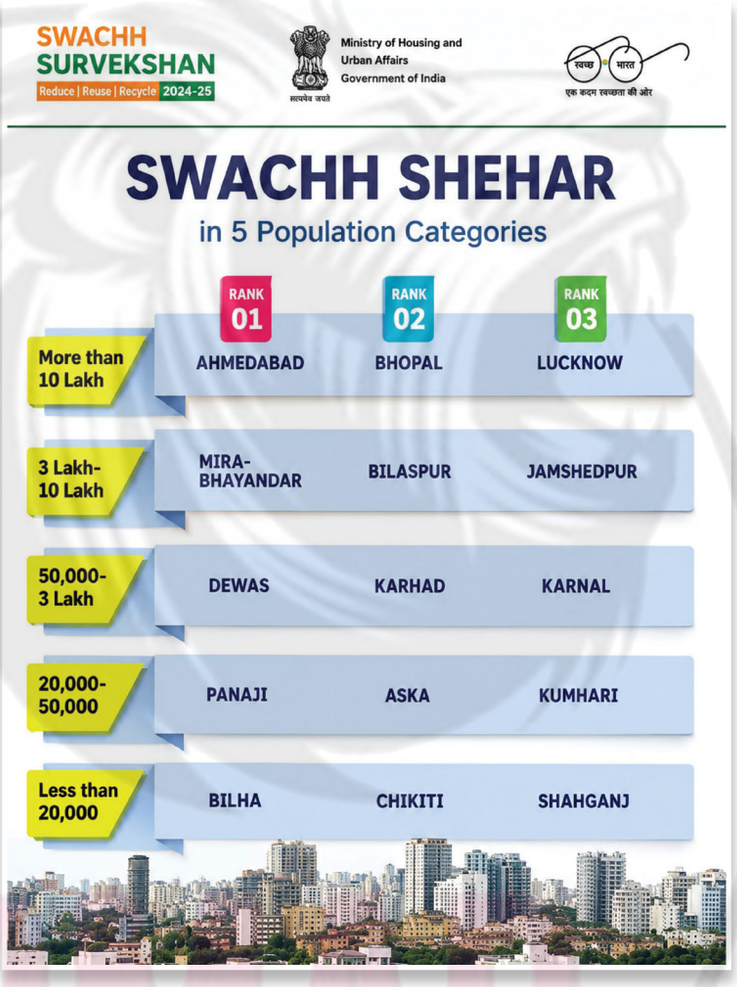
SECTORAL HIGHLIGHTS:

- **Agriculture:** Foodgrain production is estimated at a record 3,577.3 lakh metric tonnes in agricultural year 2024–25, 254.3 LMT higher than the preceding year.
- **Services:** Services exports continued to support external-sector resilience; total exports reached a record $825.3 billion in FY25 and $418.5 billion in H1 FY26.
- **Banking:** Gross NPAs fell to a multi-decadal low of 2.2% in September 2025, indicating improved asset quality.
- **Employment:** Total employment was estimated at 56.2 crore persons in Q2 FY26, an increase of around 8.7 lakh over Q1 FY26.
- **Remittances:** India remained the world's largest remittance recipient, receiving $135.4 billion in FY25.

20. SWACHH SURVEKSHAN 2024-25 AWARDS

- The Swachh Survekshan 2024–25 survey was conducted by the **Ministry of Housing and Urban Affairs (MoHUA)** under the Swachh Bharat Mission–Urban (SBM-U).





- **Swachh Survekshan Grameen (SSG)** is India's nationwide **rural sanitation assessment and ranking survey**, conducted under **Swachh Bharat Mission–Grameen (SBM-G), Phase II.**
- It has been conducted since **2018** by the **Department of Drinking Water and Sanitation (DDWS), Ministry of Jal Shakti** through an independent survey agency.

